UPCC Core Values

Teaching and Living God's Word

Our goal is to be a cover-to-cover church. We intend to teach the entire Bible "as is". We want to be culturally relevant and Biblically accurate. We trust that as we teach the Bible in a literal way, believers will live it out in a literal way.

Selfless Service

It is so easy to become selfish as believers. Our desire at UPCC is to create an environment that provides many different ways for every age group to live life in a creative and selfless way. We plan to do that through personal example and intentional teaching.

Relational Living

The Bible is a book that teaches a lot about relationships. It gives us personal examples and many principles about how to live out our Christianity with the people God places around us. We are planning to create an environment where genuine and transparent relationships can naturally occur and be developed. It is our dream that we will see a caring community that naturally lives out God's relational principles in our daily lives.

Developing Authentic Disciples of Jesus Christ

We know that in order to be all that God wants us to be as believers, we must be committed to moving forward in our Christian life. This must be planned out and intentional in a church Body. Our desire is to create opportunities and accountability to see every believer take steps toward maturity in their Christian life.

Utilizing Natural Opportunities for Evangelism

God brings us into contact with non-believers almost every day. The question is, how do we use these natural opportunities get to know these people? Although every contact may not result in an immediate opportunity to share our faith, as we intentionally live out our faith through love, and as we are sensitive to the Spirit's leading, we will see God use us to draw people to Himself. Our dream is that we, both individually and corporately, would see God use us to bring many to know Jesus Christ as Savior.

Give Generously

We are all created in the image of God- the great giver Himself! At UPCC we challenge our church body to reflect that image in the sharing of time, treasure, and talent in an abundant, joyful manner. Jesus came that we might live life and live it abundantly. What better way to do so than to live our lives with an open palm, not holding tightly to God's many blessings in our lives. Giving cheerfully and abundantly of all that God has given to each of us is one way for us to worship God every day.

UPCC's Core Values. Just how Biblical are they?

UPCC is committed to:

1. **Teaching and Living God's Word:** Deuteronomy 6:1-9; Deuteronomy 11:19; *Psalm 119:9-11, Psalm 119:97-105; *Proverbs 22:6; *Matthew 5:19; Matthew 28:19,20; Acts 4:32; *Romans 8:9-16; *2 Corinthians 5:18-20; Philippians 4: 8-9; *Colossians 2:8; Colossians 3:16; *1 Timothy 1:3-11; *1 Timothy 4:11-13; 2 Timothy 2: 14-15; 2 Timothy 3:16-17; *Titus 2:6-9; James 1:19-25; *1 Peter 2:2

2. **Selfless Service:** Deuteronomy 11:13; Joshua 22:5; *1 Samuel 12:20; Psalm 2:11; *Psalm 100:2; Micah 6:8; *Malachi 3:18; *Matthew 4:10; Matthew 7:12; Matthew 20:28; *Luke 1:74; *Luke 4: 7-8; *John 13:14; Acts 4:32-25; Acts 20:35; Romans 12:4-8; 1 Corinthians 12:5-28; *Galatians 5:13; *Galatians 6:2-5; *Ephesians 4:11-12; *Ephesians 5:17; *Ephesians 6:6-7; *Philippians 2:2-7; *Colossians 3:23-24; 1 Timothy 4:14-15; *2 Timothy 1:6; *Hebrews 6:10; *1 Peter 4:9-11

3. **Relational Living:** *Exodus 20:5-6; Leviticus 19:18b; *Deuteronomy 6:5-6; *Proverbs 3:16; *Proverbs 27:9; Nehemiah 1:5; *Matthew 7:12; Matthew 22:35-40; Mark 9:50; *John 13:34-35; John 17;21-23; Acts 2: 44,45; *Acts 4:32; *Romans 2:10, 16; *Romans 13:8-10; *Romans 15:7; 1 Corinthians 13:13; *Galatians 6:2-3; *Ephesians 5:21; Philippians 2:1-4; *1 Thessalonians 5:13, 15; *Hebrews 3:13; *Hebrews 10:24-25; James 2:1-8; 5:16; *1 Peter 1:22; *1 Peter 3:8; 1 Peter 4:7-8; *1 John 2:5-10; 1 John 3:11, 23; 1 John 4: 7-12; 2 John 1:5

4. **Developing Authentic Disciples of Jesus Christ:** *Matthew 5:14-16; Matthew 7:21; *Matthew 9:37; *Matthew 16:24-25; *Matthew 28: 18-20; Mark 10:35-43; Luke 14:27; John 8:31-32; John 15:1-8; *John 21:15-19; *Acts 14:20-22; *Romans 12:1-2; *Ephesians 4:30-32; Philippians 1:9-10; *1 Thessalonians 2:1-4; 5:11; Titus 2:1-8; 1 Peter 2:2; *1 Peter 3:8

5. **Utilizing Natural Opportunities for Evangelism:** *Psalm 103:12; Isaiah 53:6; Mark 16:14-16; Luke 23:40-43; John 1:1; *John 3:16; *John 3:36; *John 5:24; *John 14:6; *John 14: 16, 26; *Romans 3:22-26; *Romans 10:9-13; *1 Corinthians 15:3-8; 1 Corinthians 16:13; *2Corinthians 5:7; *Ephesians 2:8, 9; *Philippians 2:9-11; 1 Timothy 6:12; *1 Thessalonians 4:13-18; 1 Peter 1:7, 21; *Hebrews 11:1, 6

Doctrinal Statement of Upper Perkiomen Community Church

(Edition 10-04-09)

Scripture

We believe the Bible is the living and active revelation of God to humankind so that we may know Him and His will. The Scriptures are the very words of God that are powerful to transform lives and reveal all that is necessary for life and godliness (Hebrews 4:12-13; 2 Timothy 3:16-17).

As such the Bible is:

- The very Word of God without error in its entirety and in every part
- The authority for the faith and practice of the church and every Christian's life
- Historically consisting of the 66 books of the orthodox canon
- To be interpreted using a grammatical, historical, literal method

(Psalm 19:7-11; 119:89, 105; 2 Peter 1:20-21; Revelation 22:18-19)

God the Trinity

We believe that God is the personal, sovereign Lord of the universe who created the world, redeems it from sin, and will ultimately restore all things. God is triune, being one essence in three persons, Father, Son and Holy Spirit (Genesis 1:1; Revelation 4:11).

As such God:

- Is unique and distinct from all created things
- Is eternal and absolute, existing outside of time and space
- Created all that exists by the direct command of His voice
- Has condescended in the person of His Son to bind himself to humankind in redemption
- God the Father is worthy of all glory and worship and will sovereignly bring to completion His eternal plan for His people and His world

(John 10:30; Romans 8:28-30; Ephesians 1:11; Colossians 2:9; Hebrews 1:2-3; Revelation 4:11; Matthew 11:27; 24:36; John 8:16; Romans 8:15; Ephesians 4:6)

Jesus Christ

We believe that Jesus Christ, God's Son, is the Savior of humankind through his death on the cross and his resurrection. He is the living and powerful Lord who is worthy of all worship (Col. 1:13-20; Mark 10:45).

As such Christ:

- Is fully God and was eternally in relation to the Father as a Son
- Was born of a virgin and lived a sinless life
- Became fully human and so was fully God and fully man at the same time, without distinction or separation, without confusion or mixture of natures
- Willingly died on the cross as a substitute for human beings, fully absorbing and satisfying the wrath of God for sin by shedding His blood
- Bodily rose from the grave on the third day to demonstrate His power over death, thereby conquering sin and death and destroying their power over God's children
- Ascended into heaven where He intercedes on behalf of believers until His return to earth

(Isaiah 53:1-12; Luke 1:26-38; John 1:1, 14; John 14:6-11; Acts 1:9-10; 1 Corinthians 15:1-4, 20-28; Philippians 2:5-11; Hebrews 1:1-4; 4:14-16; 1 John 2:1-2)

The Holy Spirit

We believe that the Holy Spirit convicts of truth and sin, grants new life to those who believe in Christ, indwells all believers at the time of salvation and transforms them into the image of Christ (John 14:16-17; 16:7-15).

As such, the Holy Spirit:

- Is equal with God the Father and God the Son
- Convicts unbelievers of sin, righteousness and judgment
- Indwells, seals and sanctifies believers
- Gifts, guides, teaches, comforts and helps believers
- Restrains evil in the world until God's purposes are fulfilled

(John 3:5-7; Romans 8:1-17, 26-27; Galatians 5:16-16; Ephesians 2:18; 5:18)

Spirit Beings

We believe that God created spirit beings, some of whom remained faithful to God (angels) and worship and serve Him eternally, and some of whom rebelled (demons) and work against the plans and purposes of God until their final judgment (Isaiah 6:1-3; Ephesians 6:11-12).

As such:

- Angels are supernatural, personal beings, yet not created in the image of God
- Angels are ministers of God to carry out his purposes and aid believers
- Satan is the chief of those demons who rebelled and works to undermine God's eternal plan
- Satan is the enemy of all believers, accusing, tempting and deceiving whenever he can, and will ultimately be cast into the lake of fire along with all demons and humans who follow him.

(Job 1:6-7; Isaiah 14:12-17; Ezekiel 28:12-19; Matthew 4:1-11; 25:41; Hebrews 1:14; 1 Peter 5:8; Revelation 12:9-10; 20:1-2, 7-10)

Man

We believe that people were created in the image of God, are born with a knowledge of God, and have been cursed by sin, so that they are separated from God and stand in condemnation under his wrath (Genesis 1:26-27; Romans 5:12-21).

As such human beings:

- Are unique in God's creation, being the only part of it that bears God's image
- Are created male and female, both bearing the image of God, and equal in essence, while possessing distinct roles in the family and church
- Have inherited Adam's sin, which is the transgression of God's law
- Are born as sinners and remain so unless and until they are redeemed by God
- Are completely depraved and will not seek God until He first draws them to Himself
- Possess life beginning at conception that is to be cherished and protected until God decides to withdraw it
- Are offered the gift of marriage, consisting of one man and one woman for life

(Genesis 2:17-24; 3:1-7; Psalm 8:3-8; 58:3; Romans 1:20; 1 Corinthians 2:14; Ephesians 5:22-32)

Salvation

We believe that salvation is a free gift of God's grace based on the atoning work of Christ, and is received by repentance and faith in Jesus Christ alone (John 3:16; Titus 3:5).

As such salvation:

- Is complete union with Christ in which a believer becomes eternally joined with Christ spiritually
- Is consciously received by faith when a person freely believes in Christ as the only way to salvation
- Takes place by the regenerating power of the Holy Spirit as He convicts an unbeliever of sin, and draws that person to Christ
- Includes the legal act of justification whereby God declares a sinner to be righteous by applying the sinner's sin to Christ's account and Christ's righteousness to the sinner's account
- Includes the experiential act of sanctification whereby the Holy Spirit transforms a believer into the image of Christ
- Is an event of regeneration that takes place at a point in one's life, and a process of sanctification by the Holy Spirit that is completed only at death

(John 1:12; Romans 6:23, 10:9-10; Ephesians 2:8-9; Hebrews 9:24-28; Revelation 1:5)

The Church

We believe that the church is the living body of Christ and is his representative in this world. The church consists of all believers who have placed their faith in Christ. The church finds its primary expression in local assemblies of believers dedicated to the faithful preaching of the Word, the administration of the ordinances of baptism by immersion after salvation and the Lord's Supper, and discipline for the purity of the church (Matthew 16:18-19; Ephesians 5:25-32).

As such the church:

- Is distinct from the Old Testament people of Israel, consisting of believers from Pentecost to the rapture of the church
- Is primarily under the Lordship of Christ, its head
- Is led by pastor/elders, served by deacons, and governed by the vote of the congregation
- Is open to membership to all who confess their faith in Christ for salvation, have been baptized by immersion after salvation, and wish to follow the leadership and direction of the church

- Gathers for the purpose of corporate worship and edification and scatters for the purpose of evangelism
- Is a necessary part of a believer's life and growth, and is the training ground for serving God and each other
- Is independent of outside authority, both religious and civil, while recognizing its need to obey the laws of the land unless they clearly contradict the Scriptures
- Is called to be separate from unbelief and unbiblical practices

(Matthew 18:15-20; 28:18-20; Acts 4:32-37; Ephesians 1:20-23; 3:3-11; Colossians 1:18; 1 Corinthians 3:16; 2 Corinthians 6:14-18; 1 Timothy 2:12; 3:1-15; Hebrews 10:25; 1 Peter 5:1-4)

Future Events

We believe that Jesus Christ will bodily return to earth, remove his Bride, the Church, judge the world, and rule on earth for 1000 years before the final judgment that precedes his eternal rule (Acts 1:6-11; Revelation 1:4-8).

As such:

- The church awaits the imminent, any-moment return of Christ
- At the resurrection the souls of those who have died will be reunited with their bodies in preparation for eternity
- Jesus Christ will reward believers at the Judgment Seat of Christ for their actions after salvation
- God will condemn those who have rejected Christ to eternal separation from his presence in hell, and will reward believers with eternal bliss in heaven with Him
- Hell is a place of real, conscious torment, just as heaven is a place of real, conscious bliss

(John 5:28-29; 11:25-26; 1 Corinthians 3:11-15; 2 Corinthians 5:10; Philippians 3:20-21; 1 Thessalonians 4:13-18; 2 Thessalonians 1:5-10; Revelation 19-21)

UPCC Membership Commitment

Having received Jesus Christ as my Lord and Savior, and having been baptized by immersion following my conversion, I am in full agreement with the core values and doctrinal statement of UPCC, and now feel led by the Holy Spirit to unite with the UPCC church family. In so doing, I commit myself to God and to the other members to do the following:

1. **I will protect the unity of my church**
    - By acting in love toward other members
    - By refusing to gossip
    - By following the leaders of this church
      (Romans 15:19, I Peter 1:22, Ephesians 4:29, Hebrews 13:17)
      Unity is not the absence of enmity but the presence of knit lives

2. **I will share in the responsibility of my church**
    - By praying for its members and leadership
    - By utilizing natural opportunities for evangelism both corporately and individually
    - By pursuing relational opportunities to practice care, concern, and love both to the "household of Faith" and to those with whom I come in contact inside and outside of the church
      (I Thessalonians 1:2, Luke 14:23, Romans 15:7, John 13:34-35)
      Ownership is fully embracing and living out UPCC's vision and values

3. **I will serve in the ministries of my church**
    - By excitedly using the talents and gifts God has given to me
    - By actively pursuing opportunities to serve in a ministry within the church and ministry opportunities outside of the church
    - By passionately striving to develop a servant's heart
      (I Peter 4:10, Ephesians 4:11-12, Philippians 2:3, 4, 7)
      Service should be joyfully embraced not painfully fulfilled

4. **I will support the focus of my church**
    - By faithfully attending the Sunday morning Worship services & Connections classes
    - By investing my energy and time into developing a growing, personal relationship with God
    - By giving regularly to the general fund of the church
      (Hebrews 10:25, Philippians 1:27, I Corinthians 16:2, Proverbs 11:25)
      Involvement in the church family benefits both the giver and the receiver

By signing this form I am taking a physical step to confirm a spiritual decision I have made to live by this commitment.

Signature: _____

Spouse (if applicable): _____